

Pharmacology Review: Warfarin (Coumadin)

Warfarin is an oral anticoagulant medication used to prevent blood clots, deep vein thrombosis (DVT), and pulmonary embolism (PE).

Key Nursing Interventions:

1. Monitor International Normalized Ratio (INR) regularly. The therapeutic range for most patients is 2.0 to 3.0.
2. Monitor for signs of bleeding, including hematuria, epistaxis, melena, and petechiae.
3. Educate the patient to maintain a consistent intake of foods high in Vitamin K (e.g., green leafy vegetables).
4. The antidote for warfarin toxicity or overdose is Vitamin K (phytonadione).